

The opposition requests that any consolidation either exclude 24CV-06543 or limit consolidation for discovery purposes only.

The court denies both requests. To allow 24CV-06543 to proceed separately would not only create substantial inefficiencies for the court and parties, but it could also result in inconsistent rulings. Further, the court is not aware of any authority for consolidation only for purposes of discovery. While the parties are free to stipulate that all discovery in any of the related cases be deemed to have been propounded and answered in all of the cases, case law only recognizes two types of consolidation: that for purposes of trial only and that for all purposes. (See *Hamilton v. Asbestos Corp., Ltd.* (2000) 22 Cal.4th 1127, 1147 [Under the statute and the case law, there are thus two types of consolidation: a consolidation for purposes of trial only . . .; and a complete consolidation or consolidation for all purposes . . .].)

Accordingly, the motion to consolidate for all purposes is granted.

24CV-04539 is to be designated as the master file. All subsequent documents must be filed only in 24CV-04539. (Rule of Ct. 3.350)

Case Management Conference

Appearance required.

26CV-01625 Gayle Cloutier et al vs Richard Cloutier

Order to Show Cause Re: Restraining Order

Appearance required.

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF MERCED

Civil Law and Motion Tentative Rulings
Hon. Stephanie L. Jamieson
Courtroom 8

627 W. 21st Street, Merced

Friday May 15, 2026
9:00 a.m.

The following tentative rulings shall become the ruling of the court unless a party gives notice of intention to appear as follows:

1. You must call (209) 725-4240 to notify the court of your intent to appear.
2. You must give notice to all other parties before 4:00 p.m. of your intent to appear.

Per California Rules of Court, rule 3.1308(a)(1), failure to do both items 1 and 2 will result in no oral argument. *Note:* Notifying CourtCall (the court's telephonic appearance provider) of your intent to appear does not satisfy the requirement of notifying the court.

Case No.	Title / Description
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25CV-06130	Kanwaldeep Bains vs County of Merced, et al.
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Hearing: In Camera – Ruling

This Court, having reviewed the records that are the subject of the instant petition pursuant to the California Public Records Act (CPRA), examined the papers filed by the parties, and considered oral arguments, finds that the requested records are exempt from disclosure under the Act pursuant to Government Code sections 7927.700 and 7927.705. (Gov't Code §§ 7922.000, 7923.105, 7923.110, subd. (b).) The requested records are materials obtained during the course of a human resources investigation of a personnel matter within a county agency. The agency retained a law firm to conduct the investigation and prepare a report and recommendations based on the investigation results.

First, these records are subject to the limitations on disclosure under Government Code section 7927.700. These are personnel files and similar records, disclosure of which would constitute an unwarranted invasion of personal privacy. Although Petitioner asserts, and Respondent does not dispute, that she was affected party in the subject investigation, the CPRA is blind to the identity of the requesting party and evaluates disclosure requirements as they would apply to any member of the public. A citizen who otherwise may have a right to obtain particular records cannot avail themselves of the